



THE NAME OF THE INDIAN STATE OF RAJASTHAN derives from RAJASTHANIS

INDIA'S MOST COLORFUL RESIDENTS

the *rajputs*, a high-caste people who commonly married Mughal royalty and nobility. But Rajasthanis are descended from other tribes too. The

Holy place

Among hundreds of temples in the city of Pushkar is the only one in India dedicated to the god Brahma, the creator of the universe. Though less popular than Vishnu, the preserver, and Shiva, the destroyer, the cult of Brahma nevertheless attracts pilgrims who visit the temple and bathe in its sacred lake.



SALVATION

Devout Hindus believe that bathing in the lake can put an end to further reincarnation and guarantee instead that they will go straight to heaven after they die.

HENNA



Women through much of Asia use henna or *mehndi* to decorate their skin on special occasions. The custom originated in Rajasthan, which is still a center for the manufacture of henna.



DECORATION

The Rajasthani love of color and ornamentation can be seen not only in their own clothes but also in their animals. This cart is pulled by a donkey whose body is covered with bright splashes of paint.